

DigitalOcean is one of the fastest growing cloud vendors and offers services for just US\$ 5 a month. It runs on fast solid state drives (SSDs).

In March this year, DigitalOcean had announced a round of funding that brought in US\$ 37.5 million from investors. Droplets are deployed by users as virtual instances of operating systems. The new partnership has brought out the CoreOS as an image, which DigitalOcean customers can easily deploy as a Droplet. This partnership between CoreOS and DigitalOcean does not have a specific revenue target.

Blivet-gui—the new partition manager for Fedora

The next-gen partition manager for Fedora has been announced by developer Vratislav Podzimek and it's called Blivet-gui. This version is going to replace Gparted, which is the most popular GUI-based partition manager found in all major distros. The new Blivet-gui is based on the Blivet Python library,



which was originally Anaconda's storage management and configuration tool. This new partition manager was required as none of the existing GUI partitioning tools support all the modern storage technologies. Fedora's Anaconda base has support for all and has been chosen as the back-end for the new tool. The application has been out for just a few months now and it looks to be quite interesting and useful. More developments are awaited on features like RAID and BTRFS support.

The other developer working on this project is Vojtech Trefny. Gparted's look and feel is closely followed in this new version so that users get a familiar interface. Tasks are also handled almost in the same way as tasks are added, one by one, and then the 'Apply' button is pressed. The features that have already been implemented are: visualisation of storage devices; and creating, editing and deleting disk partitions.

The city of Turin to dump Windows XP and switch to Ubuntu

The city of Turin's municipality is hoping to save 6 million Euros in five years, as it has decided to switch to Ubuntu Linux from Windows XP, across all its offices. This means that the open source operating system will be installed on 8,300 PCs. This move will generate an immediate savings of approximately € 300 per machine. This amount will grow over the years as there will no longer be any need for the renewal of proprietary software licences. The employees will also get used to the new machines, with time. There is another reason behind this switchover. The computers currently in use in Turin's municipal offices are quite old and might not be able to efficiently support Windows 8 on them. Linux offers more flexibility with older machines. Windows XP support officially ends this year. In early August, the switch to Ubuntu was officially approved and it will take one-and-a-half years to complete the changeover.

Avnet releases Linux-ready 'PicoZed' COMs

An array of four Linux-ready 'PicoZed' COMs has been released by Avnet.



These are based on Xilinx's Zynq-7000 SoCs and integrate dual ARM Cortex-A9 cores with FPGAs. Avnet has delivered a true COM without the real-world Ethernet and USB ports. The basic design supports Linux on a variety of Xilinx Zynq-7000 system-on-chips. Avnet has spun off different versions of the MicroZed for several Zynq-7000 models. But this PicoZed is a single board which offers pin compatibility with a greater range of Zynq SoC variants. PicoZed is offered in versions that are based on Zynq-7010, -7015, -7020, and -7030 SoCs.

PicoZed is aimed at industrial controls, embedded vision, test and measurement, motor controls, and software-defined radio applications. It offers functions like memory, configuration, Ethernet, USB, clocks and power. Most of PicoZed's programmable logic I/O is expressed via a Low-Pin Count (LPC) FMC connector. Zynq models also differ in the tightly linked FPGA subsystem and it offers 53,200 look-up tables (LUTs). All four versions provide access to over 100 user I/O pins through three I/O connectors on the rear of the module for connecting Ethernet, USB, JTAG, power and other control signals. According to Avnet, the four serial transceivers on the Zynq-7015 and -7030 based PicoZeds are allocated to a PCI-Express x1 (Gen2) card edge interface, as well as the FMC connector, an SFP+ cage, and a general-purpose SMA interface.